

FREE

THE 5-MINUTE SELF-AUDIT

Why aren't recruiters messaging you?

Score your own LinkedIn profile against the 12 things recruiters actually filter on. Find out exactly where you're leaking opportunities, before you fix a single word.

For entry & mid-level software engineers

A free taste of the full LinkedIn playbook.

5 MIN • 12 CHECKS

Diagnose before you treat

Most engineers rewrite their LinkedIn headline five times and wonder why nothing changes. The problem is they're guessing at what's broken. This scorecard fixes that: it walks you through the 12 checks recruiters' search and screening actually run against, so you know precisely where you're invisible.

It's simple. Read each item, and honestly tick the box only if it's **fully** true of your profile today. No half credit. Then tally your score at the end and see where you stand. Be brutal, that's the whole point.

Four quick wins, on the house

One genuine fix from each section, no strings attached. Enough to move the needle today. The detailed approach behind each one is spelled out in the full playbook.

PROFILE

Kill the #OpenToWork ring

That green "Open to Work" ring reads as desperate, and people instinctively want candidates who look in-demand. Switch to the quieter "casually looking / flexible" status instead. Same information, opposite signal.

→ [The full profile formula is in the playbook](#)

NETWORK

Start with alumni

Below 500 connections you're nearly invisible to recruiter search. The fastest way past it is connecting with people from your school with a short "we're both from ____" note. Shared background gets accepts.

→ [Which connections actually get you scouted is in the playbook](#)

ENGAGEMENT

Liking does nothing

A like only trains your own feed. The engagement that the algorithm and recruiters actually reward is commenting, out loud, on posts in the space you want to work in.

→ [The exact way to comment so it works is in the playbook](#)

VISIBILITY

Trim your Featured section

It's a highlight reel, not your whole profile. Keep three standout items, a strong project, a credibility post, and your resume or portfolio, then cut everything else.

→ [When and what to post to get surfaced is in the playbook](#)

Now score yourself. Every box you *can't* tick is money left on the table.

Rate your profile: 12 checks

One point per box you can honestly tick. A ✓ **covered** item you can fix from the free wins on the previous page. A **FIX INSIDE** item has its exact solution in the full playbook.

1 Your Profile

/ 5

- ☐ My headline names a **specific** role, not the generic "Software Engineer." **FIX INSIDE**
- ☐ My headline also carries targeted skills and a unique selling point, and stays under 140 characters. **FIX INSIDE**
- ☐ My About section hooks in the first 2 lines, is loaded with role keywords, and ends with a way to contact me. **FIX INSIDE**
- ☐ The green **#OpenToWork** ring is off and my status is set the smarter way. ✓ **COVERED ABOVE**
- ☐ My location is set strategically to the market I'm targeting, not just where I live. **FIX INSIDE**

2 Your Network

/ 3

- ☐ I have **500+ connections** (below this, recruiter search barely sees me). ✓ **COVERED ABOVE**
- ☐ My connections are deliberately chosen, not random, to sit near the recruiters who hire for my target role. **FIX INSIDE**
- ☐ I'm connected to people who already hold the exact job title I want. **FIX INSIDE**

3 Your Engagement

/ 2

- ☐ I regularly comment with something real in my target space, not just hitting "like" (which does nothing for visibility). ✓ **COVERED ABOVE**
- ☐ My Skills section is ordered strategically, strongest and most relevant first. **FIX INSIDE**

4 Your Visibility

/ 2

- ☐ I post consistently, at the specific weekly window when LinkedIn's algorithm rewards it most. **FIX INSIDE**
- ☐ My Featured section is curated down to a few strong, credibility-building items. ✓ **COVERED ABOVE**

Add up your ticked boxes

___ / 12

What your score means

- 0-4** **Invisible.** Recruiters almost certainly aren't finding you, and if they land on your profile they're bouncing. The good news: this is the easiest score to move fast, because nearly every fix is low-effort once you know it.
- 5-8** **Getting passed over.** You show up in some searches but keep losing to better-optimized profiles. You're closer than you think, a handful of targeted changes usually flips this.
- 9-12** **Nearly there.** Your foundation is solid. Now it's about the compounding moves, network positioning, engagement, and timing, that turn a good profile into an inbox full of recruiters.

Wherever you landed, notice how many of your missed boxes were tagged **FIX INSIDE**. Each one has an exact, step-by-step fix, no guessing, in the full guide.

GO FROM DIAGNOSIS TO DONE

The full LinkedIn playbook

The complete 30-day system that turns every gap you just found into a checked box. It's what I ran on my own profile to fill my inbox with recruiter InMails and pick up 2-3 referrals in about a month.

- The exact headline formula, plus copy-paste AI prompts to build yours
- The full About-section template with a worked example
- The connection strategy that puts you in front of the right recruiters
- Why recruiters are so picky, and how to become their safe bet
- The precise posting window and what to post
- A one-page 30-day checklist to run the whole thing

[Get the full playbook →](#)

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